



2026 CITY OF VANCOUVER

Public Fireworks Celebration - Special Event

Park Board Committee Meeting
Monday, April 27, 2026



PURPOSE/OBJECTIVES

- Present the 2026 City of Vancouver (COV) Public Fireworks Celebration to the Board
- Seek Board approval for this application
- Authorize the General Manager of the Park Board to approve the detailed event terms/conditions



BACKGROUND

- Indefinite cancellation of the Celebration of Light (COL) fireworks festival announced in November 2025
- Vancouver's Mayor publicly expressed disappointment over reductions in senior-government funding; affirmed the City's willingness to explore ways to ensure a major summer fireworks celebration takes place



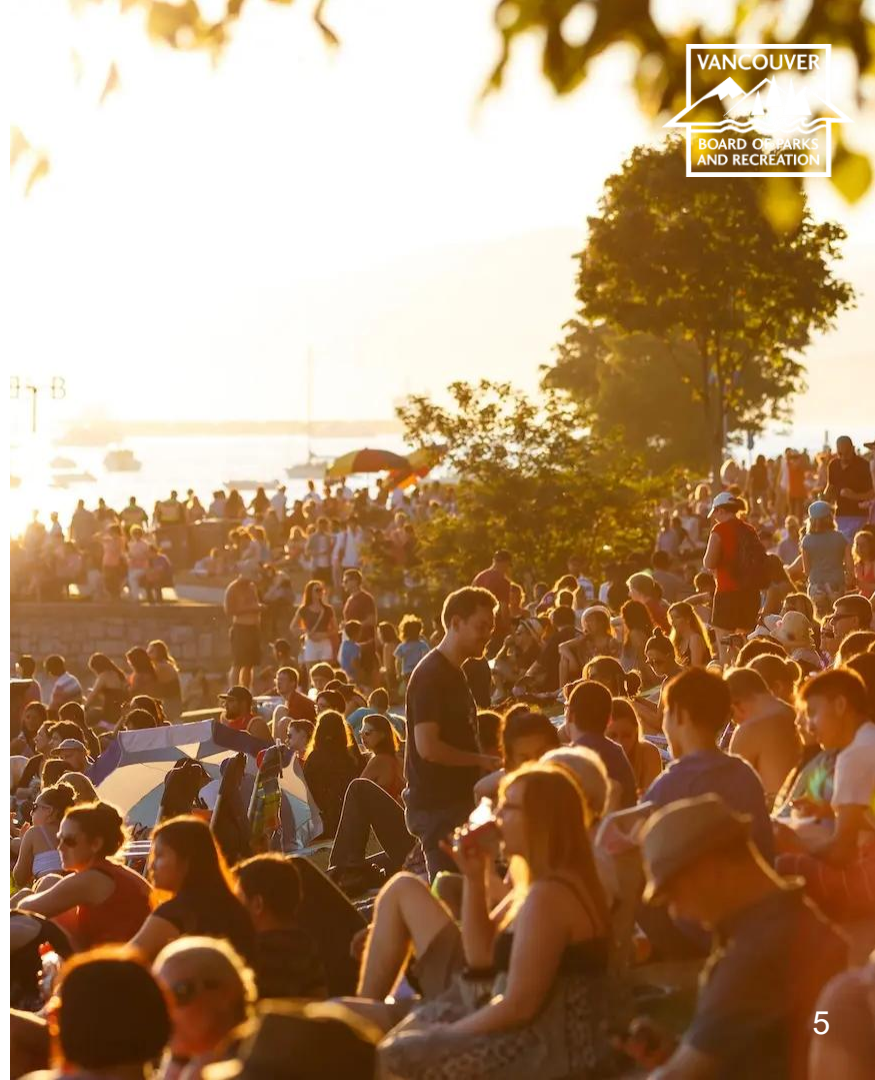
BACKGROUND

- City Council approved a motion in February 2026, directing staff to plan and deliver a one-night public fireworks event in Summer 2026
- Staff have initiated discussions and preliminary preparations for a one-night public fireworks event
- Staff are working to finalize event date and operational details



PROPOSAL

- COV is seeking approval to deliver a free and accessible one-night fireworks event at English Bay Beach Park in Summer 2026 (date to be determined)
- More detailed event planning still required
- Initiative is expected to follow a delivery model similar to COL, albeit with less features and complexity



PROPOSAL

- Event will feature a modest lounge space with alcohol service on the bathhouse rooftop and a small selection of food trucks
- Event will not include:
 - Drone show
 - The Inukshuk Lounge hosting space
 - Large grandstand seating
 - Activations in Morton Park and adjacent spaces



PROPOSAL

- Event production will be outsourced to qualified team with demonstrated experience
- NOITC issued signaling intent to engage BrandLive Group as their production partner
- Park Board will act as an event facilitator
- Event to be supported by FEST Committee and FWC26 Host Committee



PRELIMINARY SITE PLAN



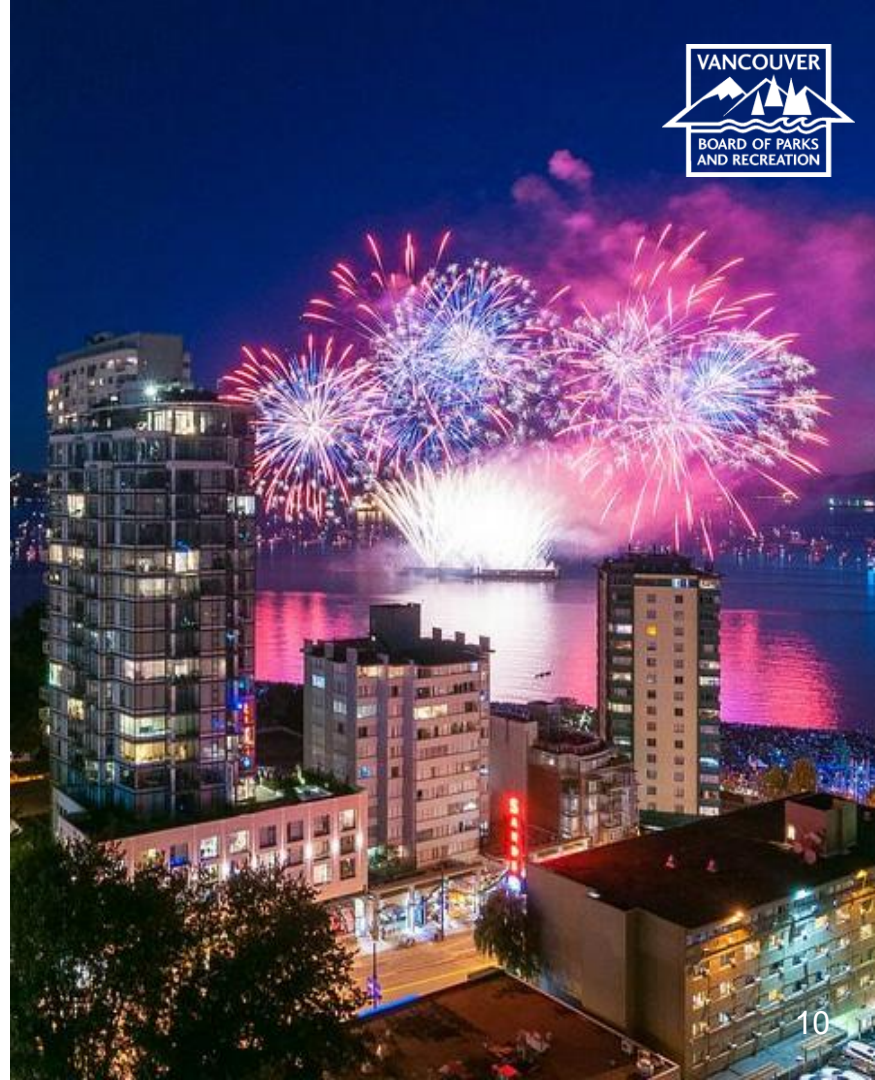
BENEFITS

- Large scale engagement of residents and visitors
- Building community connections and civic pride
- Collaboration and support for local suppliers and partners
- Promotion of Vancouver as a destination for tourism, support for long-term economic activity, and enhancement of the City's brand



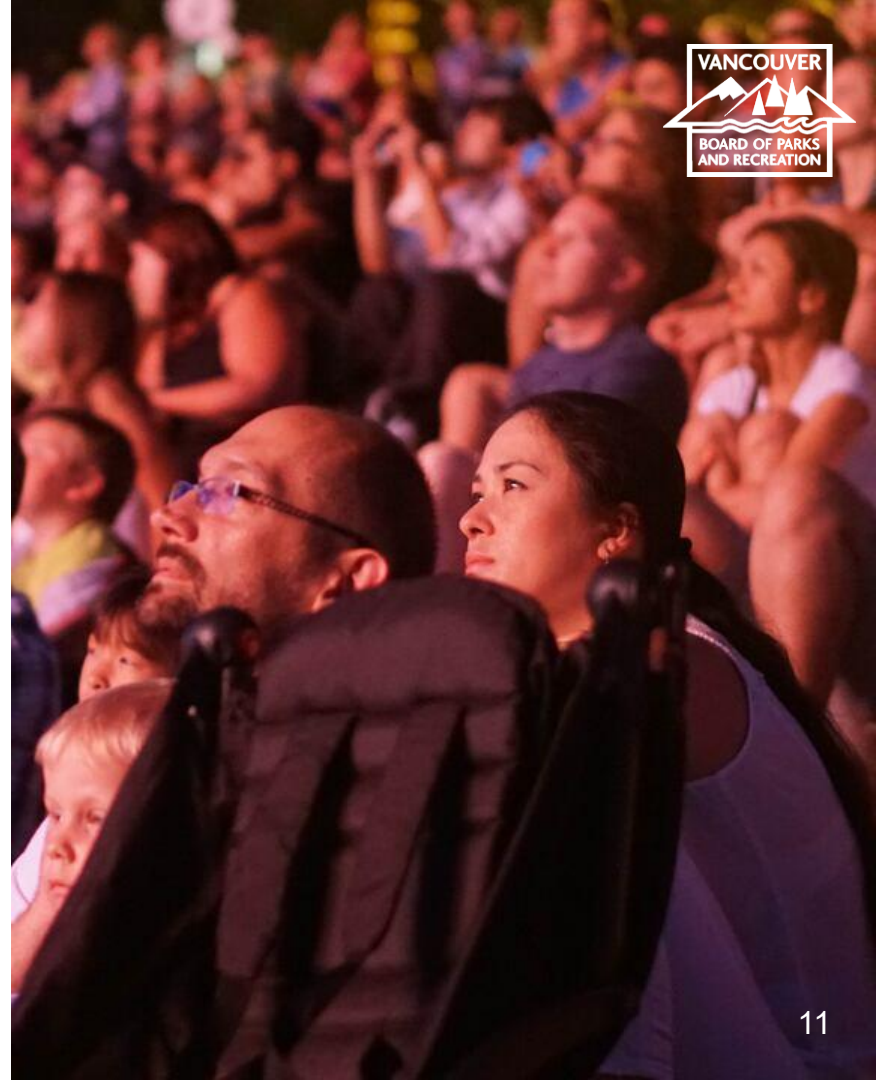
KEY CONSIDERATIONS

- Financial
 - All expenses to be borne by the event organizer; no costs to Park Board
- Beach/park access
 - Organizer will develop plan to minimize disruptions to public access
 - Set-up/tear-down timeline (4 days)
- Neighbourhood notification
 - Organizer will prepare and deliver a communication strategy/plan



SUMMARY

- 2026 City of Vancouver Public Fireworks Celebration presents an exciting opportunity to deliver a popular fireworks event to Vancouver residents and visitors
- Free and fully accessible event will showcase the City's premier waterfront spaces and contribute to the City's cultural, tourism, and economic vibrancy
- Staff have considered the many aspects of this proposal; confident it can be implemented successfully



RECOMMENDATIONS



- A. THAT the Vancouver Park Board approve an application from the City of Vancouver to host the 2026 Public Fireworks Celebration at English Bay Beach Park with all arrangements to the satisfaction of the General Manager of the Park Board.

- B. THAT the Park Board approve an application from the City of Vancouver for a Special Event Permit from the BC Liquor & Cannabis Regulation Branch to serve alcohol at the aforementioned location with a maximum capacity of 100 guests.

